Matilda Hindman and the 1890 South Dakota Suffrage Campaign

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As I was looking through *The Woman's Journal* in the Schlesinger Library's (Harvard University) digital collections for notes on suffrage in South Dakota, I noticed that Matilda Hindman wrote several substantial reports back to the *Journal* about her time in SoDak. Henry Blackwell and SDESA secretaries Moses Barker and Will Bailey did so as well, but Hindman's stood out.

I have also noticed that she does not come up on Wikipedia or major suffrage history/biography sites… so I wanted to see what else I could find, and consolidate my notes on her here. I'll add things in future if/when I find more.



"History of Mathematics at Mount Union (https://www.mountunion.edu/academics/departments/department-of-mathematics/history-of-mathematics-at-mount-union)," Mount Union College website.

Early Biography

Matilda J. Hindman was born in about 1828 and raised in Union township, Washington County, Pennsylvania. Her parents had fought for equal salaries for female teachers in their township. Her father William Hindman did so as a school committee member, and then her mother Sarah (née Campbell) continued on trying after her father's death (before the 1850 census). Three of the Hindman daughters eventually worked as teachers until the board cut their salaries by $2/month — they all quit in protest.

In 1860, Matilda Hindman was the first woman to graduate from the classical course with a B.A. at Mt. Union College in Ohio and with an M.A. in 1863, and taught mathematics at the college.

In 1872, Hindman "prominently" worked for the petition that a committee of the Pennsylvania Woman Suffrage Association (organized 1869) submitted to the state legislature's constitutional convention. In 1873, she was employed as State Traveling Agent and lecturer for the Pennsylvania W.S.A. In 1874, she led a petition that was submitted to the U.S. Senate against disenfranchising the women of Utah. She was active with the American Woman Suffrage Association in the 1870s and 1880s, serving as its corresponding secretary in 1879-1880 and financial agent and agent for the *Woman's Journal* in 1879. However, she also participated in National W.S.A. events in the 1880s. In 1881, she lectured in Pennsylvania for the National Prohibition Alliance.

In addition to her work in South Dakota, she also did suffrage campaigning in Michigan in 1874, in Iowa in 1875 and 1883-1884, in Massachusetts in 1876 and 1884, in Colorado in 1877-1878, seventeen weeks in Nebraska in 1882, and in Washington Territory in 1889. In Michigan in October 1874, at least three of her speaking locations were Black churches (African M.E. or "Colored" on the schedule she reported). In early 1884, she had been scheduled to go to Massachusetts but had to cancel because an illness in her family called her back to Pennsylvania; she was able to go later in the fall that year.

In 1887, she was enlisted to do lobbying work for the Pennsylvania W.S.A. at the state legislative session in Harrisburg. That April, The Woman's Journal reported that when the state senate passed the suffrage bill: "The gallery was crowded with ladies, who … gave the Chautauqua salute with their handkerchiefs when the vote was declared. The senators who are in favor flocked to congratulate Miss Matilda Hindman, whose months of faithful work in Harrisburg have been so far crowned with success."

In 1884-1885, she was editor of a women's department column, the "Woman's Realm," in the *Pittsburg Commercial Gazette*. In the 1875 and 1884 Pittsburgh city directories, she and her sister Jennie were recorded working as teachers and residing together; then in 1885, Matilda was recorded with the occupation of editor for the *Gazette*, and in 1887, as a lecturer.

In 1888, the Pennsylvania Women's Christian Temperance Union, which *The Woman's Journal* said "[had] never before been willing to recognize woman suffrage in any way," organized a franchise department and named Hindman as the state franchise superintendent. By February 1889, she had a third of the county WCTUs doing franchise work.

[*Biographical sources at the end…*]

My selection of some of her quotes (direct or as summarized by newspapers) *before* her time in South Dakota:

At the December 1871 annual meeting of the A.W.S.A. at National Hall in Philadelphia during delegate reports to the convention:
"She was followed by Miss Hindman, speaking for Western Pennsylvania, who had been introduced as Mrs., but who in taking the stage said she wished to make a correction. She was not Mrs. Hindman, but, was Miss H. [Applause.] Mrs. Cutler stated that the dignity of the lady's presence led her to believe that she wore the highest title. Miss H. gave it as her opinion that such was not the highest title. [Applause.]"
{*Editorial comment: Awesome.*}
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), December 9, 1871, p.387 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48852546$393i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

In 1873, she addressed the Pennsylvania state constitutional convention:
"Miss Hindman took her place on the platform, near the Chairman of the Committee, and began her address, speaking about three-fourths of an hour. She presented many arguments, to show why the Constitution should be so re-adjusted as to conform with the fundamental principles of the government, and indicated the disadvantage and injury often experienced by women in consequence of inadequate protection by law. She held that the ballot was the needed means for this protection, and the potent instrument for affording falter and fairer opportunities. The only assurance of safety to Woman rested in her permission to participate in the law-making power. Various statutes were referred to, that operated harshly on the wife respecting her property, on the mother concerning her children, and on the widow touching the guardianship of her offspring….
She believed a great many women have all the rights they want, but not all they need. She adverted to the statement frequently made, about the majority of women not wanting the ballot, but considered any argument based on this as fallacious….
She urged the Committee to take the needed step forward, and after thanking them for the privilege they had given her of asking them to do this justice, she resumed her seat."
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), January 25, 1873, p.28 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48856485$34i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"Foremost among the workers stands Miss Matilda Hindman, of Pittsburg. Her quiet, womanly method of persuasive talk with the members, the dignity no less than the ability of her arguments, place her (General Hindman as a Pittsburg paper has called her) in a position of great vantage. Her Philadelphia co-workers delight to name her as first in the good work, and feel that the battle, now half won already, would have been harder by far had she not been here."
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), February 22, 1873, p.61 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48856485$67i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"GROUNDS FOR ENCOURAGEMENT…. Everywhere increased interest is manifested by the people at large. Less ridicule is bestowed; its advocates are treated with greater kindness and respect; and the people no longer fear to express a favorable opinion. Our meetings are more largely attended; the press gives truer reports and not unfrequently aids us greatly by editorial notices urging the people to go and hear before they decide…. Let us show our faith by our works. Matilda Hindman."
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), February 14, 1874, p.50 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48856486$56i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"HONOR TO MISS HINDMAN. Editors Woman's Journal:—
I ask a small space in your valuable paper, to say a few words in regard to the work of Matilda Hindman, with and for us here in Michigan…"
Read the full editorial: *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), October 3, 1874, p.316 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48856486$322i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"Matilda Hindman in Iowa (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48859470$11i)," in *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), January 1, 1876, p.5, Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.
"Miss Hindman opened her discourse with a reference to the struggle between conservatism and radicalism that had characterized the world's history, and said that all changes for the better had been produced first by impression of wrong, then by conviction, then by agitation, followed by conflict. She gave a brief review of the condition of women in different ages and countries, comparing what has been with what is…"
{*Sounds like she was perhaps influenced by Marxism…?*}

Hindman on "The Extravagance of Women" in *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), March 18, 1876, p.92 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48859470$98i)–93 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48859470$99i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"Notes from the Lecture Field" by Hindman on p.340 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48859470$346i), and
"Miss Hindman showed conclusively that in this country the ballot enables working men to secure fair treatment and wages from their employers, while women, for lack of the ballot, were oppressed in their wages."
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), October 21, 1876, p.341 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48859470$347i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"How much women could do, if they would only openly acknowledge to their friends and neighbors their belief in the principle of Woman Suffrage. There is untold power in numbers. Thousands who believe in their hearts would announce with their lips, if it was not for fear of the many who think differently, We will never know our strength until we have some means of making known our numbers…. Boston, Mass. Matilda Hindman."
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), December 9, 1876, p.394 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48859470$399i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"FACTS AND FIGURES ABOUT WOMEN." by Hindman on women in labor and as inventors, and therefore their need for the ballot. Also, "MISS HINDMAN IN BEVERLY" a complimentary review of Hindman's presentation on suffrage by the pastor of a Methodist Episcopal church in Beverly, Massachusetts, in *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), January 6, 1877, p.5 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48859471$11i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"Testimony of Miss Hindman (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:434779279$7i)" on witnessing an election with equal suffrage in Wyoming, November 8, 1878, in *Nine Years' Experience of Woman Suffrage in Wyoming*, p.7-8, Vertical file collection, SF Suffrage – Wyoming, 1869 – 1913. Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"ANOTHER HANDFUL OF STATISTICS," on women's work in the census for Massachusetts, in *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), January 31, 1880, p.33 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48874699$39i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

A toast response by Hindman on the subject of "Co-Education" at a Mount Union Alumni Banquet in Pittsburgh, in *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), July 8, 1882, p.214 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48880298$220i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"Miss Matilda Hindman, of Pa., said:
This question of woman suffrage is not one of small importance, nor is it merely a question of voting; its rightfulness cannot be answered by a simple yes or no, nor is it a question which concerns a particular class alone, nor does it apply to a limited number of persons, but it is a question which directly effects all classes, irrespective of race, color, condition or sex. Nor is it a mere political question; it is a great and profound moral and social as well as political question… The law of reform is constant change. From conviction that wrongs exist comes investigation, agitation, conflict, change and progress… People do not give up long-established customs and much-cherished views without a struggle. They fear change and hate innovation. But, say our opponents, the world is not ready for this; those who ask the suffrage are not yet fit for the freedom it will bring. But this, as one of our leading thinkers observed, has always been the answer of those in power when redress of wrongs has been asked. Not fit, indeed! But woman has proven herself fit for many places that were closed against her a quarter of a century ago. Schools and colleges have been opened to her, and she is taking a high place among the scholars of the day. The court-house doors stand ajar, and she is entering them with womanly dignity. Freedom of speech, too, and liberty of the press are hers, and woman has not been injured by this enlarged freedom… Women, equally with men, need the ballot for protection—for protection of property, of honor and of personal rights. The foundation principle of all government is protection… And now here comes half the best citizenship of the state, asking enfranchisement; and we may be sure that their influence will be given for good to the state and to the party that first gives them political freedom and invests them with responsibility in public affairs.
Miss Hindman spoke with great moderation and clearness, and made a most excellent impression."
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), October 14, 1882, p.322 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48880298$328i)–323 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:48880298$329i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"Miss Hindman urged the importance of suffragists working inside the churches. Here is where the sympathies of society center. We have eight million professed Christians, church-members; three-fourths of these are women. Miss Hindman gave very encouraging accounts of success in enlisting the pastors and women of the churches in the suffrage work, also of the growth of woman suffrage sentiment among the temperance women of the West."
Stanton, Anthony, and Gage, eds., *History of Woman Suffrage*, vol. II (New York: Fowler & Wells, 1882), 849 (https://www.google.com/books/edition/History_of_Woman_Suffrage_1861_1876/DINKAAAAYAAJ?hl=en&gbpv=1&bsq=hindman).

At a speech in Nebraska, 1882: "The point of her remarks was that disfranchised classes in any society, regardless of form of government, are powerless to protect their own interests. In our country, she stated, twenty-five million women are disfranchised, hence powerless. As for the much lauded right to petition the government for redress of grievances, she found it largely a farce. Drunken legislators ignored women on their knees before them. Her experience with the problems of women led her to the sole conclusion that it was essential for women to have the franchise if they were to protect their property, homes and personal rights."
Coulter, "A History of Woman Suffrage in Nebraska (https://etd.ohiolink.edu/!etd.send_file?accession=osu1486644760187085&disposition=inline)," 89.

Hindman in the *Pittsburg Commercial Gazette* on "SKILLED LABOR." in *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), January 31, 1885, p.38 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49020442$44i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"IS A LAW FORBIDDING WOMEN TO WORK CONSTITUTIONAL?
Matilda Hindman, in the *Pittsburg Commercial Gazette*, calls attention to a wicked law lately enacted in Pennsylvania, prohibiting the employment of women and girls in coal and coke mines…
It may be work none of us would like to see women do; work the women themselves would prefer not to do. if they could otherwise honestly make a living for themselves and families. But with them it is a choice between this hard, rough, unpleasant work and something a thousand-fold worse. It is this work, or pauperism, theft, or prostitution…
If the State has the right to decide what is womanly work, and if it can deny women the right to do outdoor work, it can decide what is manly work and deny men the right tb engage in indoor occupations. Women in that case would probably be the gainers. Every dry-goods merchant would be subject to fine and imprisonment who would employ gentlemen clerks. Every newspaper office would be emptied of men, from editor down, except that the outdoor reporter might be retained. No minister, except the outdoor preacher, would be permitted to dispense the truths of the Gospel. Judges, lawyers, clerks, and office-boys would all be compelled to do manly outdoor work, instead of filling places nature never intended they should fill. Even male legislators might be removed to their proper sphere, where more muscle than brain is needed. They could, doubtless, find employment in the coal and coke regions of the State, and they would have no need to fear that their occupation would be taken from them by the law because it was not suitable to their manhood."

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), August 8, 1885, p.250 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49020442$256i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

An editorial by Hindman on "American Girls" in *Democratic Press* (Ravenna OH), September 3, 1885 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn83035083/1885-09-03/ed-1/seq-1/#date1=1789&index=3&date2=1963&words=Hindman+Matilda&searchType=basic&sequence=0&sort=date&state=&rows=20&proxtext=matilda+hindman&y=0&x=0&dateFilterType=yearRange&page=3).

Column by Hindman in the *Pittsburg Gazette* "Should Women be interested in municipal affairs?": "Women must keep within their own sphere, and not meddle with what concerns them not. Such is the opinion of the majority. But when we consider that women are the especial sufferers from bad government, it may possibly occur to those who have thus marked out women's sphere that it is a matter of importance to them whether the government under which they live is good or bad." *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), February 20, 1886, p.60 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49687852$68i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

Hindman "envinced both energy and enterprise in forwarding the movement through the agency of public meetings. She did good service from the beginning, relying almost solely upon her own determined purpose. Her deep interest in the work and its object, and the courage that animated her at the first impulse of duty, have continued without abatement to the present time." Stanton, Anthony, and Gage, eds., *History of Woman Suffrage*, vol. III (Rochester NY: Susan B. Anthony, 1886), 458 (https://www.google.com/books/edition/History_of_Woman_Suffrage_1876_1885/oCRBAAAAYAAJ?hl=en&gbpv=1&bsq=hindman%20).

"Miss Hindman held throughout her long life as one of her leading principals that any woman who consented to do a man's work for less than a man's wages was wronging not only her own sex, but the whole army of wage-workers." *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), April 1, 1905, p.50 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:51851248$56i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

For the South Dakota Campaign

In November 1889, Matilda Hindman arrived in California after campaigning hard for suffrage in Washington (that had been ultimately unsuccessful) and a short visit to British Columbia. While also taking time to rest in San Jose, she also lectured at several cities, including Oakland and San Francisco, and sought to raise funds for the South Dakota ballot campaign. Sen. Leland Stanford (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Leland_Stanford) (yes, that Stanford) reportedly donated $500 at her San Francisco meeting and a committee was formed there to provide sustained financial support [*Sacramento Daily Record-Union* (CA), February 2, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn82014381/1890-02-02/ed-1/seq-4/#date1=1789&index=8&date2=1963&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=Dakota+South+suffrage&proxdistance=10&sort=date&state=Alab
Sioux County Journal (IA), February 20, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/2018270201/1890-02-20/ed-1/seq-3/#date1=1789&index=12&date2=1963&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=Dakota+South+suffrage&proxdistance=10&sort=date&state=Ala
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), November 30, 1889, p.377 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49020444$383i), January 11, 1890, p.9 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$15i), March 1, 1890, p.72 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$78i), March 15, 1890, p.82 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$87i) and 85 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$91i), and May 2, 1891, p.138 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186399$146i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University].

"As all know who keep informed regarding efforts for equal suffrage, Miss Matilda Hindman, of Pittsburg, Pa., did arduous and excellent work in Washington Territory from May until October last. After the election told the story of the defeat of the righteous cause, Miss Hindman came to California, and, no whit daunted by that defeat, she turns her attention immediately to South Dakota, the next State that will offer opportunity to the electors to institute a real democracy.
Miss Hindman's presentation of facts and principles, her wise foresight regarding the necessity of preparing very thoroughly for the campaign of '90, quickly inspired her friends here, and last week a committee was formed in San Francisco which will address itself with earnest persistence to the business of raising funds to send Miss Hindman to South Dakota to co-operate with the State Association in doing the preliminary, John-the-Baptist work of preparing the way for the band of speakers who will occupy the field during the few weeks immediately preceding the election… It is good for us all to have something definite and hopeful towards and for which to work. Alida C. Avery (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Alida_Avery), San Jose, Cal., Nov. 18, 1889."
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), November 30, 1889, p.377 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49020444$383i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"Miss Hindman made a powerful plea for aid for the Dakota campaign, saying, 'Their battle is yours. Woman suffrage next fall in Dakota means suffrage sooner in California.' An effort will be made to send funds, which can be forwarded to Mrs. H. M. Barker (https://historysouthdakota.wordpress.com/womens-suffrage-in-sodak/biographies-of-womens-suffrage/helen-m-barker/), Huron, South Dakota.
Miss Hindman has done valiant work in the Golden State, and made much suffrage sentiment. Your reporter has kindliest recollections of her work in Nebraska in 1882, and was delighted to meet her still in harness."
The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), March 15, 1890, p.88 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$94i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

After California, Hindman went to Denver for a week to raise more funds for the South Dakota campaign. The *History of Woman Suffrage* claimed it was the first suffrage organization work in Colorado since a referendum measure failed in 1877 (a campaign in which Hindman had also participated) [Anthony and Harper, eds., *History of Woman Suffrage*, vol. 4 (Rochester NY: Anthony, 1902), 509 (https://books.google.com/books?id=7Y7AaItbvUwC&dq=anthony%20history%20of%20woman%20suffrage%20volume%204&pg=PA509#v=onepage&q&f=false); *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), March 15, 1890, p.82 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$87i), and March 29, 1890, p.101 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$107i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University].

In mid-March, Hindman arrived in Huron SD to be one of several visiting lecturers for the campaign of the South Dakota Equal Suffrage Association (S.D.E.S.A.). It was reported in South Dakota that her salary and expenses were being paid by the California Woman Suffrage Association. Another report claimed she "was sent to this state by a few philanthropic ladies of California." A NAWSA financial report in August 1890 recorded that California had contributed $585 to Hindman's work [*Brookings County Sentinel* (SD), March 28, 1890, pg 2 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn2001063542/1890-03-28/ed-1/seq-2/#date1=1789&index=17&date2=1963&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&lccn=sn2001063542&lccn=sn2001063544&lccn=sn2001063545&lccn=sn20 pg 5 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn2001063542/1890-03-28/ed-1/seq-5/#date1=1789&index=18&date2=1963&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&lccn=sn2001063542&lccn=sn2001063544&lccn=sn2001063545&lccn=sn20 *Union County Courier* (Elk Point SD), April 2, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn84022137/1890-04-02/ed-1/seq-1/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=6&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=Suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date&s *Wessington Springs Herald* (SD), April 4, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99067997/1890-04-04/ed-1/seq-2/#date1=1789&index=2&rows=20&words=Hindman+Matilda&searchType=basic&sequence=0&state=South+Dakota&date2=1963&proxtext=matilda+hindman& *Hot Springs Star* (SD), April 4, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn96090256/1890-04-04/ed-1/seq-4/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=10&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=Suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date& et al.; *The Daily Plainsman* (Huron, SD), May 13, 1890 (https://www.newspapers.com/clip/25501315/the_daily_plainsman/); *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), March 15, 1890, p.82 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$87i), and August 30, 1890, p.277 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$283i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University].

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), April 12, 1890, p.120 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$126i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"MATILDA HINDMAN IN SOUTH DAKOTA. Huron, South Dakota, April 3,1890.

Editors Woman's Journal: Miss Matilda Hindman, of Pennsylvania, arrived in this city a few days since, ready for work in the cause of equal suffrage. Though worn by her long service in California and by the long and weary journey to us, she exhibits great zeal in the work that has such a hold upon her life.

Miss Hindman addressed a large and responsive audience in this city, and carried the people by storm with her womanly ways and pleasing address. She is, as you know, a superior speaker, eloquent, earnest and. persuasive. Her sweet face, pleasing manners, and womanly address, together with her unanswerable arguments and logical and eloquent presentation of woman's claim to equal franchise with man, place her in the front rank as a lecturer in the present campaign for equal suffrage in our State. The executive committee feel themselves peculiarly fortunate that they have been able to secure the services of so estimable a lady.

She is now in the field hard at work lecturing and organizing local clubs. She has addressed large audiences at Brookings, Elkton, White, Parker and other important towns, at each of which she organized suffrage clubs of seventy or more members. She will canvass the southern tier of counties, and then work northward until she meets other organizers who are working in the northern and central counties.

At a meeting of the executive committee of the South Dakota E. S. A., which was held April 2, at their headquarters in this city, the following resolutions were unanimously adopted: Resolved, That we welcome Miss Matilda Hindman to our State, and recommend her to the suffragists as an earnest worker of large experience, as a gifted speaker and an able organizer. Resolved, That we tender to the California friends who, by their generous contributions, have enabled her to come to us, our heartiest thanks and appreciation of their great kindness."

In early April 1890, Hindman was in Parker SD where she lectured on suffrage at the opera hall for a large audience and organized a county equal suffrage association after the First District W.C.T.U. convention that was being held there. She also organized an equal suffrage association at the opera hall in Hurley to the south [*Turner County Herald* (Hurley SD), March 27, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn2001063133/1890-03-27/ed-1/seq-1/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=15&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=Suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date&
April 10, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn2001063133/1890-04-10/ed-1/seq-1/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=18&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=suffrage+Suffrage&proxdistance=5&s
The Union Signal, "Page 36 (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14562)," and "Page 70: Programme of W.C.T.U. Convention (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14819)," Emma Smith DeVoe: 1880-1890 (Scrapbook D), WSL Manuscripts, MS 171, Box 10; *Madison Daily Leader* (SD), April 10, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99062034/1890-04-10/ed-1/seq-2/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=19&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=suffrage+Suffrage&proxdistance=5&s

At 8 p.m. on Monday, April 21, Hindman lectured at the Methodist church in Elk Point. The event notice in the paper said "She comes free of charge to us, and entertains* herself. California foots the bills. Please note that this line of work is entirely distinct from the Temperance work; because you are a member of the W.C.T.U. it does not follow that you are obliged to be a suffragist. The lady has come a long way, and courtesy demands that we give her a good audience, although you may not agree with her in sentiment, come out and hear her. Sec'y." Forty people reportedly joined the suffrage association she organized at the meeting. With her Elk Point stop, she also scheduled lectures in Richland on Tuesday, at the Edwards school in Virginia Township on Wednesday, at Alcester on Thursday, and at Beresford on Friday [*Union County Courier* (Elk Point SD), April 9, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn84022137/1890-04-09/ed-1/seq-3/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=16&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=Suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date&
April 23, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn84022137/1890-04-23/ed-1/seq-3/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=4&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date&s
**Entertaining meant hosting a visiting speaker in a private home – food, conversation, board, and the time & effort that that required.*

"Miss Matilda Hindman is doing excellent work. She is a grand woman, and the people take to her. She is womanly, eloquent, strong and persuasive. From simple, truthful premises she leads her hearers on by easy steps of logic to irresistible conclusions. And most happy are we that the friends of woman's enfranchisement in California have made it possible for us to have her valuable services. She reports her work to this office each week… She is well received by the people wherever she goes, and her meetings are largely attended."

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), April 19, 1890, p.124 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$130i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), April 26, 1890, p.130 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$136i)–131 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$137i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"MISS HINDMAN IN DAKOTA. Henley, So. Dak., April 8, 1890.

Editors Woman's Journal: I find but little time now to write even private letters, but this is a work in which our friends everywhere must take an interest and extend all the aid possible, if we hope to succeed. In all my work heretofore I have never found so hopeful a field. We can win here, with proper help; but the truth is there is no money here to pay even the expenses of speakers. That kind of help must come from outside.

The work here is in good hands. I find the State committee composed of able, capable, earnest, and I believe most trustworthy persons. Their plans for organizing are well laid, and are being carried out most successfully. Mrs. Barker (https://historysouthdakota.wordpress.com/womens-suffrage-in-sodak/biographies-of-womens-suffrage/helen-m-barker/) is an able woman, one who has influence all over the State, so far as I can learn, and upon whose judgment and honesty all rely. I can truly say I have never before had my meetings so well arranged and so well advertised, except in our campaign in Western Pennsylvania two years ago, when my sister planned and arranged the meetings. And never before have I had such successful, enthusiastic meetings as in this State during the two weeks I have been here. The audiences are large at every place; often the house has been crowded. I have spoken in the churches in every town except this, and here they have a good hall in a central location. The meetings are attended largely by voters.

I have spoken every night, and one afternoon, when I addressed the Farmers' Alliance in convention in the town of White. Besides speaking every week evening, I have held Sabbath evening meetings and also afternoon meetings in a few towns. During these two weeks I have held seventeen meetings, and organized eleven societies with a membership of over five hundred. In one town of 500 people, we organized with 116 members, 61 of whom are voters; in another town of less size, with 71 members, the majority of whom are voters. Fifty-two gave their names in a town where less than 60 votes were cast at the last election, and it was an election when every voter was out. Last evening, in a little town of less than 300 inhabitants, 40 became members.

The people everywhere seem very enthusiastic; but we must remember we do not meet our opponents. I believe the liquor men are already at work to defeat us. The election of town officers in certain towns proves this. We shall not win without a hard fight; and much of our success depends upon proper organization and judicious management.

I see by the *Tribune* that California is reported to have raised funds sufficient to keep me in the field during the whole campaign. That is a mistake. The friends in that State have contributed what will keep me here until the middle of May, as far as the salary is concerned. The full expenses are not paid for that time. I think they will send more; but there ought to be thousands of dollars given by friends to carry on this work here. The Prohibitionists carried their amendment, but they spent money, energy, everything to get the subject before the people. There are men here who can and will speak for us, but of course the people are in too straitened circumstances at present to give money.

The people here are intelligent, generally well-informed, and brave of heart. They are a good class of people, and desire good government. The leading citizens everywhere are at the head of this work. Matilda Hindman."

"Miss Matilda Hindman is hard at work on her field. She is doing a grand work for the cause. She has been speaking every night and organizing clubs, riding twelve to fifteen miles over the wide and wild country. The Dakotas are a country of magnificent distances. She sometimes organizes her club after midnight, and then rides a long distance for entertainment. Farmers come many miles to attend her meetings, bringing their entire families… M. Barker (https://historysouthdakota.wordpress.com/womens-suffrage-in-sodak/biographies-of-womens-suffrage/reverend-m-barker/), Sec'y."

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), May 10, 1890, p.152 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$158i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

In her first six weeks, she organized seven counties. On Monday, May 12th, she spoke to suffragists at the G.A.R. Hall where they finalized their leadership for Beadle County and selected committees on work. The *Plainsman* described her as "a very earnest, logical speaker." From Huron, she planned to go south and campaign through Sanborn County and on through Lake, Moody, and Minnehaha Counties [*The Daily Plainsman* (Huron, SD), May 13, 1890 (https://www.newspapers.com/clip/25501315/the_daily_plainsman/); *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), May 24, 1890, p.168 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$174i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University (– the schedule published by SDESA as follows)].

- Letcher May 15
- Woonsocket May 16
- Artesian May 17 and 18
- Roswell May 19
- Vilas May 20

- Howard May 22
- Winfred May 23
- Madison May 24 and 25
- Wentworth May 26
- Colman May 27
- Egan May 28
- Flandreau May 29
- Sioux Falls May 30 and 31
- Minnehaha County June 1, 2, 3 and 4

At Woonsocket, she reportedly "organized an association with 160 members, many of them leading business men of the city" [*The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), May 31, 1890, p.172 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$178i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University].

In late May, she may have departed temporarily from her intended schedule and joined up with Susan B. Anthony. According to a local newspaper Hindman spoke in Alpena (Jerauld Co.) the night after Anthony did so, hosted by the local W.C.T.U. The paper reported that she had "an equally large and appreciative audience" and she "left the impression upon all, that this lady also had full control of her subject; after which there was an equal suffrage club formed with upwards of forty members, with the promise of large additions in the near future. It is a most excellent and encouraging beginning" [Quoting the *Alpena Journal* in *Wessington Springs Herald* (SD), May 23, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99067997/1890-05-23/ed-1/seq-1/#date1=1789&index=8&date2=1963&words=Millikin+Mrs&searchType=basic&sequence=0&sort=date&state=South+Dakota&rows=20&proxtext=mrs.+millikin

Back on schedule in Madison on May 24 and 25, she spoke on that Saturday evening at the Methodist Episcopal church—afterwards organizing an association with elected officers—and then gave a lecture on Sunday afternoon at the opera house for a larger audience "and made a strong plea for the cause to which she is devoting her life" [*Madison Daily Leader* (SD), May 26, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99062034/1890-05-26/ed-1/seq-3/#date1=1789&index=4&rows=20&words=Hindman+Matilda&searchType=basic&sequence=0&state=South+Dakota&date2=1963&proxtext=matilda+hindman& Jennings, "Lake County Woman Suffrage Campaign in 1890 (https://www.sdhspress.com/journal/south-dakota-history-5-4/lake-county-woman-suffrage-campaign-in-1890/vol-05-no-4-lake-county-woman-suffrage-campaign-in-1890.pdf)," *South Dakota History* 5(4) (1975), 399].

She was not always successful… In Egan, she apaprently failed to get any of her lecture audience to sign up for an equal suffrage association [*Madison Daily Leader* (SD), June 3, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99062034/1890-06-03/ed-1/seq-2/#date1=1789&index=1&rows=20&words=Hind+Matilda&searchType=basic&sequence=0&state=South+Dakota&date2=1963&proxtext=matilda+hind&y=0&x=(

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), June 14, 1890, p.185 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$191i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"MISS HINDMAN IN DAKOTA. Sioux Falls, So. Dak., June 6, 1890.

Editors Woman's Journal: Organization is an absolute necessity at this time, and every township in the forty counties east of the Missouri River could be organized with comparatively little outlay.

I have been in the State ten weeks. During that time I have had arranged for me sixty-nine public meetings, at all of which except two I have lectured, and I have organized in every place in which I held meetings. I am organizing Sioux Falls and the county of Minnehaha at present. Sioux Falls is the largest town in the State, and it is really the most important place. There is more opposition here than elsewhere, and there are as many voters in this town and county as in a half dozen counties, all told, in many sections of the State.

Miss Anthony is to hold a county convention here the 17th and 18th, and with the aid of the good friends here, I am making all possible efforts to have most of the townships represented and send the delegates home prepared to do effective work in their own localities from now until the election. My plan from the first has been to get as thorough organization as possible in the county before holding the county convention; then come up and have a grand rally of the friends from all parts of the county. Many of the conventions have been held in unorganized counties; but that will probably, arouse the people so that they will organize themselves.

I have never before worked in a State where the people seemed so willing to hear the subject discussed and were so ready to organize for work. Even Norwegians and Swedes come to my meetings, and acknowledge themselves converted to the doctrine and willing to work-in the societies. These are a moral, industrious and thrifty people, and I find that the way to reach them is to show what an advantage it will be in securing good government and keeping tricky politicians from ruining the nation. This I believe will be the result of doing justice to women. These men can readily see the advantage that it will be to them to have a good government, and though some of them have thought little of the need of justice to women, they know that their women believe in what is right, and would vote for the right.

My last meeting was held in a community of Scandinavians. Only one American family was in attendance. It was a full meeting, held in the school-house. The strictest attention was given, and at the close of the meeting I organized with eighteen members, thirteen of whom were voters.

We must go to these country districts. These men can easily be won over to vote right. They cannot go to the towns to attend meetings and conventions. It takes both time and money to do so, and they have neither to spend in that way. I regret exceedingly that there is no plan for raising funds for carrying this work to a successful issue. Gentlemen speakers, when of the right kind, have a great influence on the voters. The friends in this county were organized last fall when Miss Anthony was here. I came the first week of May. They had been entertained during the interval with two good addresses, but they had not done anything themselves, not even held one meeting. At the afternoon meeting of the members who met me on my arrival, it was arranged that the organization should be more active, and the organizing of committees for work was completed before the evening meeting. When I returned, three weeks after, I found that the committees had done good work. A number of educated ladies and gentlemen were pledged to go to the different townships in the county to speak and organize, so that there will be not less than twenty-five organizations in this county represented in the county convention on the 17th and 18th. Two ladies and one gentleman of these workers are teachers in the City High School. Others take their buggies and drive into the country to do this work. With the small sum of $1,500, I could have every county so organized by the first of September. That is, every township would have a working force to see that voters have an opportunity to hear the subject discussed, and also to attend to the proper arrangements on election day.

Our prohibition friends won because they worked for success. They used the means to win. They raised money to get the subject fairly before the people. They were well organized. The home speakers did a great deal of the work. It is said that many of the people mortgaged their homes to aid in raising funds for the cause, and now rejoice they did so. Will the friends of woman suffrage do as much? If not, why? This is a question of greater magnitude—a question upon which the welfare of the people as well as the safety of the commonwealth more largely depends. If those who see this clearly would do all in their power to enlighten others, the good work would soon be accomplished.

Matilda Hindman."

In June, Hindman did organizing work through Codington, Clark, and Deuel Counties [*Dakota Ruralist*, June 28, 1890, "Page 42 : Entire Page (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14596)," Emma Smith DeVoe: 1880-1890 (Scrapbook D), WSL Manuscripts, MS 171, Box 10].

That month, her sister Jennie Hindman made appeals to local Presbyterian churches in Pittsburgh for funding to send to the South Dakota suffrage campaign — "The United Presbyterian Churches of Pittsburgh have the honor of being the first to take up as churches the work of aiding the South Dakota campaign. Let other churches follow this good example." They also sent Rev. J.T. McCrory to join Matilda Hindman in the lecture field [*The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), June 21, 1890, p.194 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$199i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University].

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), July 5, 1890, p.212 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$218i)–213 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$219i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"THE CAMPAIGN IN SOUTH DAKOTA. Elrod, S. D., June 25, 1890.

Editors Woman's Journal: The questions— (1) What news can you give us from South Dakota? (2) How is the cause of justice progressing? (3) Will victory come to the right at the November election? — these questions reach us from all parts of the land. It is due to the friends of woman suffrage everywhere, especially to the noble-hearted friends who have so generously given material aid, and added thereto sympathy, kindness, and love, that we answer as best we can these inquiries.

What news? Will it be news to state that politicians are always politic? Politicians here are no exception to their kind elsewhere. Two of the political parties seem to think it best to hold on to the bird in the hand rather than to risk catching the one in the bush.

The Democratic party held its convention and scouted the idea of endorsing woman suffrage.

The Farmers' Alliance, at its nominating convention, refused to put a suffrage plank in the platform, but passed a resolution favoring the principle. This means, 'We will do nothing to help carry the suffrage amendment unless we can be convinced it will help us.'

Time will show what the Republican party will do at its convention, August 25.

How is the cause of suffrage progressing? Just as fast as you, dear friends, determine that it shall progress. Emerson says, "No man can learn what he has not . . . the preparation for learning." Our eyes are holden that we cannot see things that stare us in the face, until the hour arrives when the mind is ripened—then we behold them. These people have had no opportunity of learning the truths we are teaching. Their eyes are holden until they receive instruction, and when the needed information is given, they see the right and accept the truth gladly.

Proof of this has come to me at every one of the eighty-four meetings I have held during the past ninety days. 'You cannot organize here,' they will say, 'because nobody, or few, believe in woman suffrage.' Yet, when I have spoken and am ready to organize, a large proportion of the audience give their names as believers, ready to work to secure the adoption of the suffrage amendment. Our chief hope of victory in this contest is in getting the subject fairly understood by the people in the rural districts. It is through the township and school district meetings that this is to be done. It will require honest, earnest, good speakers to do this. Organizing must be done in the country districts by those who hold the meetings. Indeed, this should be done everywhere by each speaker who addresses an audience where a society has not been formed. It is not necessary to hold a dozen meetings to convert the country people. With unprejudiced, thoughtful minds they listen to the statements made, and with due consideration accept the truth and ever after hold thereto. They do not laugh, clap, and cheer over the witty sayings and happy hits of a speaker, and then go away without having a single grain of the principle advocated implanted in their mind. They go to the meetings to get information, and to receive instruction.

Especially in this state, they seem deeply interested in the moral welfare of the people, the improvement of society, and in whatever tends to better the government.

With the dwellers in cities it is different. Their rushing, busy, money-making lives have a tendency to distract the mind, to make it forget the higher and more unselfish duties of bettering society and securing justice for the weak and oppressed. Wearied with business cares, they attend meetings for rest. They are amused and pleased with the witty, sarcastic and possibly brilliant sayings of the speaker, and are equally pleased and amused with the misrepresentation, and the unfair, cold and cruel criticisms of the opposing editor in the next morning's paper.

This counteracting influence of adverse press criticism never touches the country hearer. He hears, forms his opinion, and decides for himself without waiting to read the morning editorial before making up his mind. Thus the leaven of truth which the speaker leaves with him, has both time and the proper conditions to work, and by November 4, the whole country will be leavened. Those who do this country organizing and speaking will find it humble, laborious, unhonored and fatiguing work. They must be willing to be abased that the cause may be exalted. It is this humble, unobtrusive work that will bring freedom to women. The school-house meetings are always largely attended. Sometimes the audience is composed entirely of Scandinavians. They reason well and are easily convinced. They do not wish to he thought to change their opinion too suddenly. 'I believe this is just. Women should be treated justly; I will do all in my power to secure their rights for them; but I came here well grounded in disbelief of this subject. Now I will study this carefully, for I do not wish to have the wool pulled over my eyes,'—said a Scandinavian to me. I assured him that my intention was not to pull the wool over his eyes, but off from them. He and his neighbors gladly received the literature, saying they would read carefully, and they earnestly requested that another speaker be sent them.

A constant appeal for speakers comes to me from societies which I have organized. The people everywhere want meetings held in their schoolhouses. If every township in each county could be organized and the people set to work, we would have an educating system such as we have never had in any State before, and would soon have a force that no political party could afford to ignore. With the work that has been done already, this can be accomplished, at least one month before the election, if the plan that presents itself to my mind be adopted by those having this work in charge, and if the friends will exert themselves to raise funds for the purpose. This will prove the most economical way

> of getting the people educated. In this way the third question,— Will victory come to the amendment on the fourth of November? can be answered in the affirmative.
> Fifty-eight of my meetings have been held in Orthodox churches, seventeen in schoolhouses, five in halls, two in waiting-rooms at railroad stations, one in a Court House, one in the open air. I have addressed two conventions of the Farmers' Alliance, and am chosen orator of the day for an equal suffrage rally at Watertown, July 4.
> Matilda Hindman."

On July 8, 1890, Hindman gave one of the speeches and a report on her field work at the state suffrage convention held in Huron to re-organize the state leadership [*Madison Daily Leader* (SD), July 10, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99062034/1890-07-10/ed-1/seq-3/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=14&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date& "Page 44 (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14625)," "Page 45 (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14640)," and *The Dakota Ruralist*, July 19, 1890, "Page 44 (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14625)," Emma Smith DeVoe: 1880-1890 (Scrapbook D), WSL Manuscripts, MS 171, Box 10].

After the convention, Hindman spoke in Aberdeen on July 11-13th and gave an open-air address at Amherst on July 15th. She continued on through the northeastern part of the state, Brown, Day, Grant Counties etc. ["Page 45 (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14640)," "Page 46 : Appointments (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14645)," (schedule following) and "Page 48 (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14661)," Emma Smith DeVoe: 1880-1890 (Scrapbook D), WSL Manuscripts, MS 171, Box 10; *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), July 26, 1890, p.250 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$256i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University].

- Amherst July 15
- Britton July 16-17
- Langord July 18
- Bristol July 19
- Webster July 20-21
- Blue Lake July 22
- Waubay July 23
- Sand Cut July 24
- Twp work July 25
- Milbank July 26-27
- Big Stone City July 28
- Wilmot July 29-30
- Twin Brooks Aug 1
- Andover Aug 2
- Twp work Aug 3-9
- Aberdeen Aug 10
- Ordway Aug 11
- Columbia Aug 12
- Hecla Aug 13
- Frederick Aug 14
- Westport Aug 15
- Aberdeen Aug 16
- Groton Aug 17
- Bath Aug 18
- Warner Aug 19
- Mansfield Aug 20

The schedule changed a bit, because at 3 p.m. on August 1, Hindman was in Milbank, where the Grant County Equal Suffrage Association was thoroughly organized at a convention at the Methodist Church, that started [*The Herald-Advance* (Milbank SD), August 8, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn00065154/1890-08-08/ed-1/seq-4/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=13&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=suffrage+Suffrage&proxdistance=5&s
On August 4, she gave a talk to "a small audience" at Andover, where spoke over an hour but only two gave their names as supporters [*Madison Daily Leader* (SD), August 19, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99062034/1890-08-19/ed-1/seq-2/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=17&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date&

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), August 23, 1890, p.270 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$276i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University.

"CAMPAIGNING IN DAKOTA. Aberdeen, S. D., Aug. 8, 1890.

Editors Woman's Journal:

To you who are enjoying the cool, 'health-giving' breezes of ocean, lake and mountain, we dwellers of the far-off plains send greetings.

Are we alive? Know ye not that in 'the land of the Dakotas' heat hath no power to kill? Health and long life come from the calm, quiet, uncomplaining spirit of the people. Here they seek not health resorts. Their homes on these treeless, shadowless plains are not to be despised, not to be forsaken for some supposed more comfortable retreat. The mountains are hundreds of miles away, but they sigh not for them. With no lakes, no streams, no rain-falls to cool the air, they are cheerful and happy. The ocean breezes, having travelled thousands of miles, come to them scorching in the form of 'hot winds,' blasting, biting, and burning all they touch, yet these people complain not. This year these winds have fairly cooked the crops of wheat and oats that stood almost ready for the reaper, have roasted the corn, scorched the flax, and burnt up the grass.

We poor mortals have escaped the terrible fate of the crops only through the kindness of 'Mother Nature.' Drawing the curtains of darkness around us once every twenty-four hours, she kindly says: 'Rest in peace. I will supply you with an abundance of cool, aye, cold air, until the morning light returns.' She makes no false promise. Thus the boiling blood is cooled, the equilibrium restored, and life sustained. 'All that a man hath will he give for his life.' All that a woman hath not (suffrage) will she give for a breath of life-giving air, if she be not a Dakotian.

But life is ours, and suffrage will come to these brave people whom neither hot winds, lack of rain, nor loss of crops can discourage.

Personally, I can report that my work goes on regularly, and more successfully than at any time before since I entered the State last March. I have held sixteen meetings during the past fourteen days. Two of these were county conventions, where many townships were represented by delegates. In most instances, the delegates were chosen at the meetings I held in the county before the convention. No delegates except those who knew they could attend were elected; thus interested friends, willing to work, were in attendance.

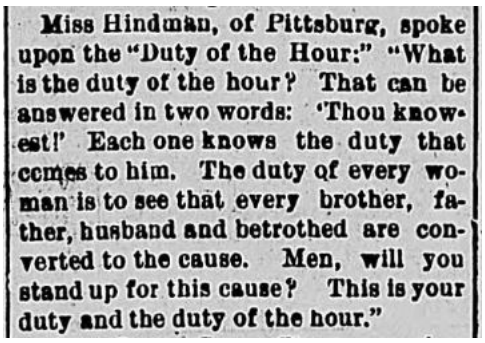
A plan of work was laid out, so that in a short time every township in the county will be organized by the citizens of the townships, and the whole county canvassed, so that the name of every voter will be obtained, and his views on the suffrage amendment secured. Women volunteered to do this work—wise, thoughtful, earnest women, who will do good work. During this extremely hot weather the meetings have been largely attended, the houses often being crowded. There have been only two exceptions. One of these failures was due to lack of proper advertising. In one town, the editor, in his report of the meeting, stated that it was the largest meeting ever held in the town during his residence there. Certainly the people in the small towns and country places are deeply interested, and our hope of victory lies in getting the subject fairly before the country people.

I would most earnestly beseech the friends not to send speakers to the towns before the middle of September. Already the larger towns have had speakers, but the great country districts lie ready, willing and waiting to hear the words of truth. Farmers have, after their hard day's work in the hay-fields, driven their tired teams miles, bringing wife, children, baby and all to attend my meetings. I, at the same time, having enjoyed the healthy exercise of a buggy drive of fourteen, and, occasionally, sixteen miles between supper and bed-time, giving an address, organizing a society of forty or fifty members, composed of these same intelligent men and women, have fully appreciated the sacrifice they were making for a cause they believed In. Surely we have no reason to be hopeless in regard to carrying a cause that has such friends!

The convention for Brown and Marshall Counties will be held August 16, in Aberdeen. From now until August 23 I shall hold meetings every evening in Brown County.

Matilda Hindman."

On August 25-26, 1890, the S.D.E.S.A. held a state convention at the rink opera house in Mitchell, in advance of the state Republican convention held at the same location in the days following. Hindman and the other out-of-state lecturers then in South Dakota all came to Mitchell convention. During the Tuesday afternoon session, she spoke on the topic the "Duty of the Hour" [*Mitchell Capital* (SD), August 8, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn2001063112/1890-08-08/ed-1/seq-4/#date1=07%2F01%2F1890&index=3&date2=09%2F10%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&lccn=sn2001063112&words=suffrage&proxdista August 29, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn2001063112/1890-08-29/ed-1/seq-1/#date1=08%2F01%2F1890&index=8&date2=08%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=Convention+convention+republican+R *Madison Daily Leader* (SD), August 8, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99062034/1890-08-08/ed-1/seq-3/#date1=01%2F01%2F1890&index=14&date2=10%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date& et al.; "Page 31: Program from 1890 South Dakota Equal Suffrage Mass Convention (http://primarilywashington.org/items/show/14499)," Emma Smith DeVoe: 1880-1890 (Scrapbook D), WSL Manuscripts, MS 171, Box 10].


Miss Hindman, of Pittsburg, spoke upon the "Duty of the Hour:" "What is the duty of the hour? That can be answered in two words: 'Thou knowest!' Each one knows the duty that comes to him. The duty of every woman is to see that every brother, father, husband and betrothed are converted to the cause. Men, will you stand up for this cause? This is your duty and the duty of the hour."

Mitchell Capital (SD), August 29, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.lo
1/#date1=08%2F01%2F1890&index=8&date2=08%2F31%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=Convention+convention+republican+R

In September 1890, Hindman appeared with Anna Howard Shaw and the WCTU's Susan Fessenden at the SD WCTU convention in Madison, and she went to St. Lawrence (Hand County) to spoke on suffrage during a district G.A.R. reunion event [*Hand County Press* (Miller SD), September 11, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn98062948/1890-09-11/ed-1/seq-1/#date1=1777&index=8&date2=1963&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&lccn=sn98062948&words=suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date&rows=20 Mary Kay Jennings, "Lake County Woman Suffrage Campaign in 1890 (https://www.sdhspress.com/journal/south-dakota-history-5-4/lake-county-woman-suffrage-campaign-in-1890/vol-05-no-4-lake-county-woman-suffrage-campaign-in-1890.pdf)," *South Dakota History* 5(4) (1975), 406].

On September 13, 1890, Hindman was in Wessington Springs for a Jerauld County suffrage convention at the Methodist Episcopal church. The local newspaper (edited by suffrage supporters Linus and LoElla Blank (https://historysouthdakota.wordpress.com/womens-suffrage-in-sodak/biographies-of-womens-suffrage-b/)) printed the notice in the convention call: "Come early tomorrow morning; bring your lunch basket and dinner in the park, and leave things at home in such a condition that you can stay all day, and to the lecture in the evening." Unfortunately, the suffrage meeting was scheduled in conflict with the county Farmers' Alliance convention that same day so their business meeting was a small one, "many of the most active members being in attendance at the county Alliance in session at the court house at the same hour." Hindman also had been invited to address the Alliance convention, so it was worked out that the suffrage meeting would adjourn to attend her talk at the courthouse, then she gave her main lecture that evening at the church. After her evening address, there was a response by Rev. Mr. Campbell and several other short speeches "showing a deep interest in the subject" [*Wessington Springs Herald* (SD), September 5, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99067997/1890-09-05/ed-1/seq-8/#date1=1789&index=1&rows=20&words=Hindman+Matilda&searchType=basic&sequence=0&state=South+Dakota&date2=1963&proxtext=matilda+hindman& September 19, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99067997/1890-09-19/ed-1/seq-8/)].

On Hindman's lecture:

> "The great need of our country is law abiding citizens. She gave statistics of the penitentiaries in the United States showing that only one woman to eighty men are criminals. Should the most law abiding class be disfranchised? Men say politics are corrupt. How can it be otherwise when the moral element of our nation is excluded from taking part in its management. One good effect of equal suffrage is shown in Wyoming which is the only state where it is a crime to offer a woman lower wages than would be offered to a man for the same amount of work."
>
> *Wessington Springs Herald* (SD), September 19, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99067997/1890-09-19/ed-1/seq-8/).

The Woman's Journal (Boston MA), October 18, 1890, p.332 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$338i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University

GOOD WORK OF MATILDA HINDMAN. St. Lawrence, S. D., Oct. 11, 1890.

Editors Woman's Journal: I want to bear witness through your columns to the effective and most excellent suffrage work lately done in Hand County…. The work is being pushed. Every township but one in this county of forty townships had representatives in this convention.

Miss Matilda Hindman has held fourteen meetings, most of them being in country churches and school-houses (which no previous speaker had done). Two of these meetings were open-air assemblies, one at a large picnic and rally at Merritt's Grove, in the south-eastern part of the county; the other in our beautiful grove here at St. Lawrence. She spoke at this meeting to the G. A. R., who were encamped here. The close attention with which the old veterans listened to her words, was remarkable for an out-of-doors hearing, and gave flattering hopes for the success of our cause. Miss Hindman is convincing and logical. Every word carries weight. She is pleasant and entertaining, and says no harsh words of the men. We wish she could be in a dozen places at once in our new State, and that every voter might hear her… Miss Hindman is now at work in the southern and river counties, with the same grand result…

Yours, sanguine of victory, at least in Hand County, M. B. Horning."

In October-November, her schedule included the following stops. The Parkston, Milltown, and Olivet stops were arranged for by E.L. Swartz, who wrote that Hindman had suggested holding a county convention but begged off from speaking at it herself [Letter from E.L. Swartz (https://sddigitalarchives.contentdm.oclc.org/digital/collection/p15914coll4/id/388/), September 22, 1890, #2021-02-02-0042, Box 6674, Folder 5, WCTU Suffrage Correspondence 1890: R-Z, H91-74, Pickler Papers, SD State Archives; *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), October 11, 1890, p.324 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$330i), and October 25, 1890, p.340 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$346i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University]:

- Armour Oct 13
- Grand View Oct 14
- Parkston Oct 15
- Milltown Oct 16
- Olivet Oct 17
- Scotland Oct. 18-19
- Springfield Oct 20
- Running Water Oct 21
- Tyndall Oct 22
- Bridgewater Oct 23
- Baker Oct 24
- Sioux Falls and vicinity Oct 25 to Nov 3

On November 3, she was at the opera house in Madison with Rev. Olympia Brown for that city's last equal suffrage rally before the election the next day [*Madison Daily Leader* (SD), November 4, 1890 (https://chroniclingamerica.loc.gov/lccn/sn99062034/1890-11-04/ed-1/seq-3/#date1=11%2F01%2F1890&index=2&date2=11%2F15%2F1890&searchType=advanced&language=&sequence=0&words=suffrage&proxdistance=5&sort=date&s

Although the amendment failed at the ballot, South Dakota suffragists were grateful to the numerous visiting speakers.

> "The friends of the cause in South Dakota have been untiring in their devotion. The suffragists who went from other States to aid in the work have spared neither time nor strength. It has been a great battle to establish a government truly representative of the whole people, men and women. The result will be awaited with the deepest interest on both sides of the Atlantic by those who on the two continents are striving to secure equal human rights. South Dakota will always be grateful to the brave women who have worked so unselfishly for the Woman Suffrage Amendment… They all gave up easy conditions to endure months of fatigue and privations for the enfranchisement of women. l.s. [Lucy Stone]."
>
> *The Woman's Journal* (Boston MA), November 1, 1890, p.349 (https://iiif.lib.harvard.edu/manifests/view/drs:49186398$355i), Schlesinger Library, Harvard University

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After South Dakota

Hindman returned to Pennsylvania from Washington and South Dakota at the end of November 1890. In the 1891 and later directories for Pittsburgh, Matilda was recorded as a lecturer and continued living with her sister Jennie, a teacher, at various residences.

Her first project was "to effect an organization… to commemorate woman's work in the discover of America in the erection of a Queen Isabella statue."

She was also president of the Pittsburg Women's Suffrage Association and served as Pennsylvania's VP for the Women's National Federal Suffrage Association. She continued occasionally to give addresses outside the state, including in Wisconsin and New York, and her sister Jennie at least occasionally helped with scheduling her appearances.

Upon her death in 1905 at her family home near Monongahela, she was buried at the Mingo Presbyterian Church near Finleyville PA. At the time of her death, she bequeathed everything, including $7,000 of real estate in Knoxville Borough PA (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Knoxville,_Pennsylvania), to her sister Jennie.

Sources for pre/post-South Dakota Biographical Info:

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Biography, Women's History

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